



Incident Response Plan

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Table of Contents

Purpose..... 3

Key Terms..... 4

Incident Response Team (IRT) 7

Testing and Review..... 16

Appendix-A Incident Impact Definitions 18

Appendix-B Incident Severity & Response Classification Matrix 18

Appendix-C Incident Report Form..... 20

Purpose

The Security Incident Response Plan provides a systematic incident response process for all Information Security Incident(s) that affect any of Falconi's information technology systems, network, or data, including Falconi data held, or services provided by third-



party vendors or other service providers. From time to time, Falconi may update this policy and implement different levels of security controls for different information assets, based on risk and other considerations.

This plan applies to all Falconi assets utilized by personnel acting on behalf of Falconi or accessing its applications, infrastructure, systems, or data. All personnel are required to read, accept and follow all Falconi policies and plans.

Scope

Falconi intends for this plan to:

- Define the security incident response process and provide step-by-step guidelines for establishing a timely, consistent, and repeatable incident response process.
- Assist Falconi and any applicable third parties (including vendors and partners) in quickly and efficiently responding to and recovering different levels of information security incidents.
- Mitigate or minimize the effects of any information security incident on Falconi, its customers, employees, and others.
- Help Falconi consistently document the actions it takes in response to information security incidents.
- Build trust.

Key Terms

Information Security Incident	Any actual or reasonably suspected unauthorized use, disclosure, acquisition, access, corruption, deletion, or other processing of sensitive information that may compromise its confidentiality, integrity, or availability
Data Breach	A confirmed incident in which sensitive or confidential Falconi data is accessed,



	disclosed, modified, or destroyed without authorization.
Post-Breach Response	Activities following mitigation, including notifications, legal coordination, public relations, policy updates, and other remedial measures.
Corrective Action Plan	A documented set of follow-up tasks that close control gaps uncovered during the incident and strengthen Falconi's security posture.
Incident Log	The chronological record maintained by each IRT member detailing actions taken, timestamps, findings, and decisions throughout the incident lifecycle.
Personally Identifiable Information (PII)	Data that can identify an individual (e.g., name, address, date of birth) and triggers heightened protection and notification of duties if compromised.
Tabletop Exercise	A discussion-based simulation where the IRT walks through a hypothetical incident to validate readiness without disrupting live systems.
Insider Threat	A breach or harmful act caused, maliciously or negligently, by a Falconi employee, contractor, or partner with legitimate system access.
Malware Attack	Malicious software (virus, ransomware, spyware, etc.) deployed to disrupt, damage, or gain unauthorized access to Falconi systems.
Social Engineering	Manipulative tactics (phishing, pretexting, etc.) that exploit human behavior to obtain confidential information or system access.
Unauthorized Access	Entry into Falconi systems, data, or resources by an actor (internal or external) without explicit permission.
Denial of Service (DoS)	An attack aimed at rendering Falconi services or networks unavailable to



	legitimate users by overwhelming resources or exploiting flaws.
Security Controls	Administrative, technical, or physical safeguards (policies, firewalls, IAM, etc.) Falconi employs to protect information assets.
Preparation Phase	Pre-incident activities, training, log configuration, risk assessments, that establish Falconi's readiness; referenced as "excluded" from the response timeline but still foundational.
Post-Mortem	The retrospective meeting held after resolution, where senior management and the IRT review root causes, document key learnings, and assign improvement actions.



Incident Response Team (IRT)

Falconi has an Incident Response Team (IRT) that provides timely, organized, informed, and effective response to information security incidents to (a) avoid loss of or damage to the Falconi systems, network, and data; (b) minimize economic, reputational, or other harms to Falconi and its customers, employees, contractors and partners; and (c) manage litigation, enforcement, and other risks. The IRT consists of:

Role	Responsibility
Incident Response Manager (Lead)	Oversees all incident response efforts, coordinates team actions, and reports to executive leadership; any real security incident should be escalated to the IR Manager from the SOC Analyst
SOC Analyst	Monitors real-time alerts, filters false positives, and escalates true incidents to the Lead Analyst; first to receive the alert and determines the initial severity of the incident
Digital Forensics Investigator	Collects and analyzes digital evidence, preserves chain of custody, and identifies root causes and attackers
Head of External Communications	Manages all communications with media and all other entities not within Falconi. Additionally responsible for communicating work being done to effectively and efficiently resolve the incident
Head of Internal Communications	Manages all internal communications within Falconi. Reviews and publishes all messaging to current Falconi employees about incident status, next steps, etc.

Note: The above list is just a sample of the full IR team roster. The current IRT roster may be contacted at servicedesk@Falconi.com.

Incident Response Process



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The Incident Response Plan is activated or enabled when a security incident occurs, and the IRT is responsible for evaluating the situation and responding accordingly. The process outlined below should be followed by the appropriate Staff at Falconi in the event of an Information Security Incident. Falconi shall assign resources and adopt procedures to timely assess automated detection results, screen internal and external reports, and identify actual information security events. All identified incidents must be documented using the Incident Report Form (Appendix C).

Detection and Reporting

Automated Detection

Falconi uses automated tools such as Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS) and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms to monitor systems for signs of suspicious activity or policy violations. These systems may automatically alert the IRT when:

- Unusual network traffic is identified, such as connections to blacklisted IPs and unauthorized server communication
- New user account or privilege escalation attempts occur
- Multiple failed log-in attempts and account lockouts

Report from Employees

All Falconi employees are required to report any suspected security incident or vulnerability as soon as possible.

If you believe an incident occurred or may have identified a threat, vulnerability, or other security weakness, please report it to servicedesk@Falconi.com. This is the preferred method and should be used whenever possible. Include:

- Date/time of the incident
- What you observed
- Systems or accounts affected
- Any supporting evidence (e.g. screenshots)

If our email system is unavailable, or has been compromised, please submit a ticket through the secure incident report form at falconi.com/ServiceDesk, or call the Falconi IT Hotline at (973) 555-1532.



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Once an incident has been submitted, please stop using the affected system immediately. Do not attempt to investigate this issue on your own, retain any relevant logs or error messages, and wait for clearance from the IRT before resuming work on the affected system.

External Source

External sources, including Falconi customers or third-party vendors, who claim to have information regarding an actual or alleged information security incident should be directed to servicedesk@Falconi.com. Employees who receive emails or other communications from external sources regarding information security incidents that may affect Falconi or others, security vulnerabilities, or related issues should immediately report those communications to and should not interact with the source unless authorized.

All communications with external parties regarding potential or active incidents must be handled by authorized Falconi personnel in accordance with the Incident Response Plan.



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Response Procedures

Responding to a data breach involves verification, assessment, information recording, containment and mitigation, and post-breach response.

Information recording is very important during an incident, not only for effective containment and eradication efforts, but also for post-incident lessons learned, as well as any legal action that may ensue against the perpetrators. All of the steps must be documented in an incident log (see Appendix C). The response procedure is not purely linear, as these stages and the activities associated with each stage frequently overlap.

Verification

Upon receipt of a security alert or report, the Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst will work with Falconi employees and contractors to identify the affected systems or hardware and determine the nature of the data maintained in those systems or on the hardware. Then, they will determine whether the activity meets Falconi's criteria for a security incident based on thresholds defined in Appendix B.

If the activity is suspected to be an actual security incident, the SOC Analyst escalates the case to the Incident Response Manager. They will be responsible for formally declaring whether the situation constitutes a security incident, assign an initial severity level based on the nature and scope of the event, and activate the Incident Response Team as needed.

Incidents are very confidential topics and as such, all of the information gathered should be kept on a need-to-know basis, unless applicable laws or a management decision instruct us otherwise.

Assessment

Following verification of an Information Security Incident, the Incident Response Team (IRT) will determine the level of response required based on the incident's scope, affected systems and data, and potential risks to Falconi's operations, customers, employees, or reputation.

The incident assessment must identify what employees or contractors were affected, what customers were affected, and what data was potentially exfiltrated, modified, deleted or compromised.



Key assessment considerations include whether sensitive or regulated data was involved, such as personally identifiable information (PII) or payment information, and whether the breach originated internally or externally. The Incident Response Team must also determine whether the incident was caused by a malicious actor or the result of human error. Additionally, it is important to assess whether the breach originated from a compromised insider account, an external threat actor, or a physical loss of equipment.

If Falconi determines that the breach may trigger legal or regulatory reporting obligations, the IRT will:

- Notify legal counsel
- Coordinate outreach to appropriate law enforcement agencies
- Ensure that such coordination follows relevant breach notification laws and Falconi's internal reporting procedures

All contact with law enforcement must be conducted under the direction of legal counsel in collaboration with the IRT to ensure proper handling of evidence, chain of custody, and compliance requirements.

Containment and Mitigation

As soon as Falconi has verified and assessed the breach, the IRT must take all necessary steps to contain the incident and return the Falconi systems back to their original state and limit further data loss or intrusion.

Such steps may include:

- Acting to stop the source or entity responsible, for example by:
- taking affected machines offline;
- segregating affected systems; or
- immediately securing the area if the breach involves a physical security breach.



- Determining whether other systems are under threat of immediate or future danger.
- Determining whether to implement additional technical measures to contain the data breach, such as changing locks, passwords, administrative rights, access codes, or passwords.
- If it's suspected that the attacker is still connected, avoid immediately shutting down or disconnecting affected systems, as this may result in loss of critical logs and data.

Before any systems are shut down or rebooted, it is important to document and preserve any logs related to the data breach. This preservation is critical for legal, forensic, and internal audit purposes. The following steps should be taken to ensure proper preservation:

- Any relevant logs should be immediately saved and secured
- Logs should be encrypted and saved in a secure environment to ensure their integrity for later use
- If a system must be taken offline, collect memory dumps, running process lists, and active connections using approved tools

The Incident Response Team must coordinate with the legal team to ensure that all evidence is preserved in a manner admissible in court or regulatory proceedings.

Post-Breach Response

Post-Breach activities are critical to restoring Falconi's operation, complying with legal obligations and ensuring continuous improvement in our incident response procedure. The following are key elements to Falconi's post breach response.

Depending on the severity of the data breach, the Incident Response Team in collaboration with the legal team and the social media team will coordinate all communications related to the breach.

- Internal Communications: Timely notification to affected business units, executive leadership, Human Resources, and IT staff with need-to-know access.



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- **External Communications:** Depending on the severity, the communication to affected customers, partners, vendors, or regulatory bodies as required by applicable regulations. This may include information about:
 - Nature of the breach
 - Type of data involved
 - Estimated scope and impact
 - Steps Falconi have and will take to remedy the situation
 - Guidance for affected parties
- **Public Statements:** Depending on the severity of the incident, the social media team may issue a public statement in correspondence with the Incident Response Team. Public statements to the media will be reviewed and approved by both the Incident Response team and the legal team.

Falconi will comply with all state, federal, and international regulations in respect to issuing notifications about incidents. The Incident Response team will work closely with the legal team to determine which regulations they must follow, and the proper actions necessary to uphold the law.

All forensic digital evidence relevant to the breach must be preserved for investigative, legal, and audit purposes including but not limited to:

- Network traffic captures
- Communication records
- Security logs
- Screenshots collected during the incident
- Any other documentation related to the incident and Falconi's response

Falconi will review applicable access controls, policies and procedures and determine whether to take any actions to strengthen the organization's information security program.

Post-Mortem



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The post-mortem is a structured retrospective meeting conducted after a security incident has been resolved. It involves reviewing the incident and analyzing all the impacts it had. The goal is to improve future response efforts by outlining specific action items to strengthen Falconi's security policies, procedures, and training.

- Executive Summary – provide a concise overview of the incident, including what happened, when it was discovered, how long it persisted, and which systems or data were affected.
- Timeline – document a chronological sequence of key events, from detection, through containment, to recovery. Include exact timestamps when possible.
- Impact Analysis – describe how the incident affected Falconi's operations, services, customers, or partners. Include scope of data compromised, duration of outages, and any regulatory exposure.
- Root Cause Analysis – explain the underlying cause of the incident, such as a misconfigured system, human error, third-party failure, or successful phishing attempt. Identify whether it was due to process gaps, technical flaws, or policy violations.
- Response & Communication – document who was notified, when, and by whom. Detail internal and external communications, public statements, customer notifications, and regulatory reports.
- Lessons Learned – summarize what went well during the incident response, what didn't, and how response can be improved in future events. Highlight any procedural, communication, or tooling shortcomings.
- Action Items – list all remediation tasks and preventive measures identified. Include updates to security controls, employee training needs, system reconfigurations, and policy revisions. Assign deadlines and owners if available.

Key Learnings

As soon as the incident has been resolved, Falconi senior management should meet with the IRT and other relevant team members of the Falconi for a post-mortem to better understand the incident that took place and determine how similar incidents may be prevented in the future. The retrospective should be documented and key learnings from the retrospective should be presented to all appropriate team members in a timely manner. These insights should be evaluated in compliance with Falconi's business



objectives. The organization should update its security goals, policies, and practices to ensure continued alignment.



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Testing and Review

Testing the plan annually is critical to ensuring the plan is effective and practical. Any gaps in the plan that are discovered during the testing phase will be addressed by Falconi management. All tests must be thoroughly documented. Testing of this plan may be performed using the following methods:

Walkthroughs

Team members walk through the steps documented in this plan to confirm effectiveness, identify gaps, bottlenecks, or other weaknesses. This walkthrough provides the opportunity to review the plan with a larger subset of people, allowing the team to draw upon an increased pool of knowledge and experiences. Team members should be familiar with procedures, equipment, and offsite facilities.

Tabletop Exercises

An incident is simulated, so normal operations will not be interrupted. Scenarios of various security incidents are used, and this plan is put into action to determine its effectiveness.

Validated checklists can provide a reasonable level of assurance for many of these scenarios. Analyze the output of the previous tests carefully before the proposed simulation to ensure the lessons learned during the previous phases of the cycle have been applied.



Acknowledgement

- All Falconi employees and contractors must report any suspected or confirmed security incidents immediately to servicedesk@falconi.com. Reporting promptly ensures swift action to mitigate and contain the incident.
 - Upon notification of an incident, Falconi personnel must cease use of the affected system or device until clearance is provided by the Incident Response Team (IRT).
 - External communications concerning any security incidents must only be conducted by authorized Falconi personnel and according to the predefined communication plan.
 - Falconi's Incident Response Team (IRT) is responsible for assessing, containing, and mitigating incidents. Cooperation with the IRT is mandatory during incident investigations and response efforts.
 - Employees and contractors must participate in periodic incident response training and exercises, as required, to ensure preparedness and effective incident management.
 - All actions taken during an incident must be accurately documented using the Incident Log and Incident Report Form provided by the IRT.
 - Upon resolution of an incident, Falconi personnel are expected to participate in post-mortem reviews and implement corrective actions identified to prevent future occurrences.
 - Any failure to adhere to this Incident Response Plan may result in disciplinary action, including termination and potential legal consequences.
- ☐ By acknowledging this policy, you confirm that you have read, understood, and agree to comply with the security protocols and responsibilities outlined above.

Signature

Date



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Appendix-A Incident Impact Definitions

Security Objective	Impact	Low	Medium	High
Confidentiality	Unauthorized disclosure of sensitive information that could adversely affect Falconi operations, assets, or individuals.	Limited to a few users or devices; isolated event; easy remediation.	Internal breach of sensitive info (e.g., salary data); limited or no external exposure.	Severe breach of proprietary data with confirmed or likely external exposure.
Integrity	Unauthorized modification or destruction of information that could negatively impact operations, assets, or individuals.	Inadvertent or non-malicious data alteration; easily remediated.	Ongoing malicious or negligent alteration with moderate business impact.	Widespread malicious destruction or alteration of critical data.
Availability	Disruption of access to or use of information or systems that could negatively impact operations or services.	Isolated and brief outage (< 2 hours); affects a limited number of users.	Widespread outage of a primary business system lasting > 2 hours but < 1 day.	Major outage or system inaccessibility lasting 1+ day; significant operational disruption.

Appendix-B Incident Severity & Response Classification Matrix

Potential impact is dependent on the situation (internal, external, legal, reputational).



Severity Level (Decreasing Level)	Typical Incident Characteristics	Example of Impact	Incident Response
4	Critical breach; widespread system compromise with; sensitive data breached	An enterprise-wide attack involving multiple departments that prevents access to systems and disrupts business operations. Access to or theft of proprietary data.	Activate full IRT. Contain and remove threat. Notify leadership and legal. Begin recovery, forensics, and external coordination. Prepare required notifications.
3	Targeted attack; limited system compromise	Employee computer or account with sensitive data access compromised physical theft of device, unprotected media, or hard copy data.	Activate full IRT. Isolate affected system(s), notify legal and IT leads, begin internal investigation and recovery.
2	Malware Infection: Minor data access leaked	Company communication resources (email, phone system, etc.) may be compromised during a severe incident.	Engage IRT lead. Scan and remove malware, restore affected services, monitor for signs of escalation.
1	Low Risk vulnerability	A minor software or configuration vulnerability is discovered that does not currently expose sensitive data or systems. No active exploitation detected. Routine business operations remain unaffected.	Investigate the issue. Patch vulnerability during next maintenance cycle; monitor for exploitation attempts.

Appendix-C Incident Report Form

Executive Summary	Brief overview of the incident, including what happened, when it occurred, and its potential impact.
Incident Details	• Incident ID: • Date/Time Detected: • Reported By: • Detection Method: (e.g. IDS alert, employee report) • System(s) Affected: • Incident Type: (e.g. phishing, malware, data breach) • Incident Severity Level:
Description of the Incident	Detailed timeline of events, actions taken, and how the threat was identified. Include any indicators of compromise (IOCs).
Impact Assessment	• Data Compromised (if any): • Systems Outage/Downtime: • Business Operations Affected: • Users Impacted:
Mitigation & Containment Steps	Describe what was done to contain and mitigate the incident, including any emergency actions or patches applied.
Lessons Learned & Protection	List improvements to systems, processes, or employee training that can prevent future incidents.
Supporting Attachments	Include any logs, screenshots, or forensic reports relevant to the incident.

Documented by:

